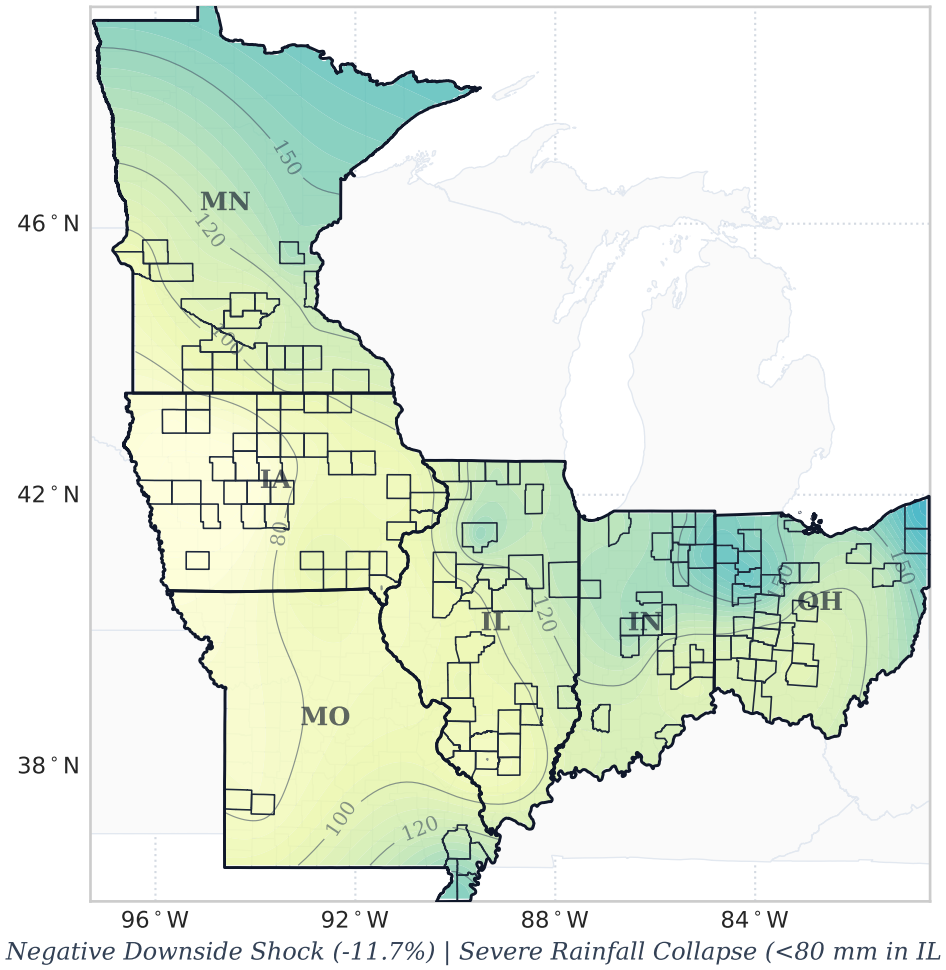
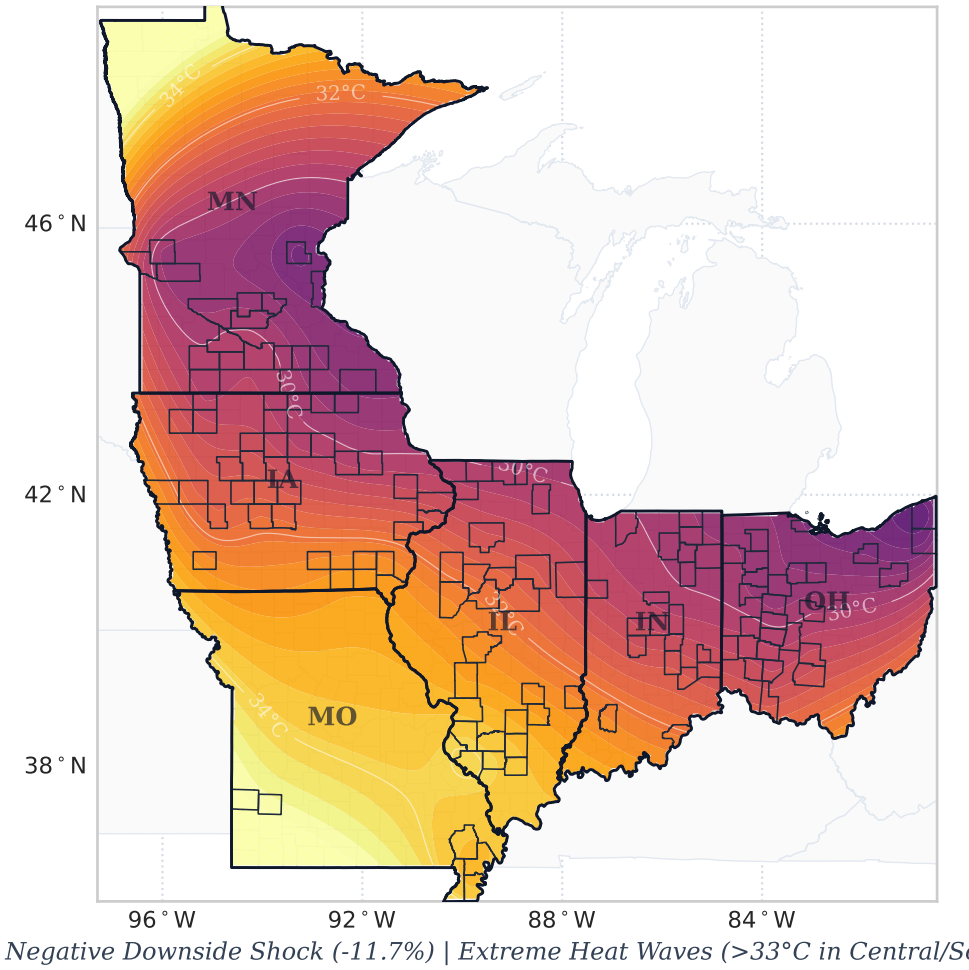
(a) 2012 Flash Drought: July–August Rainfall (P)



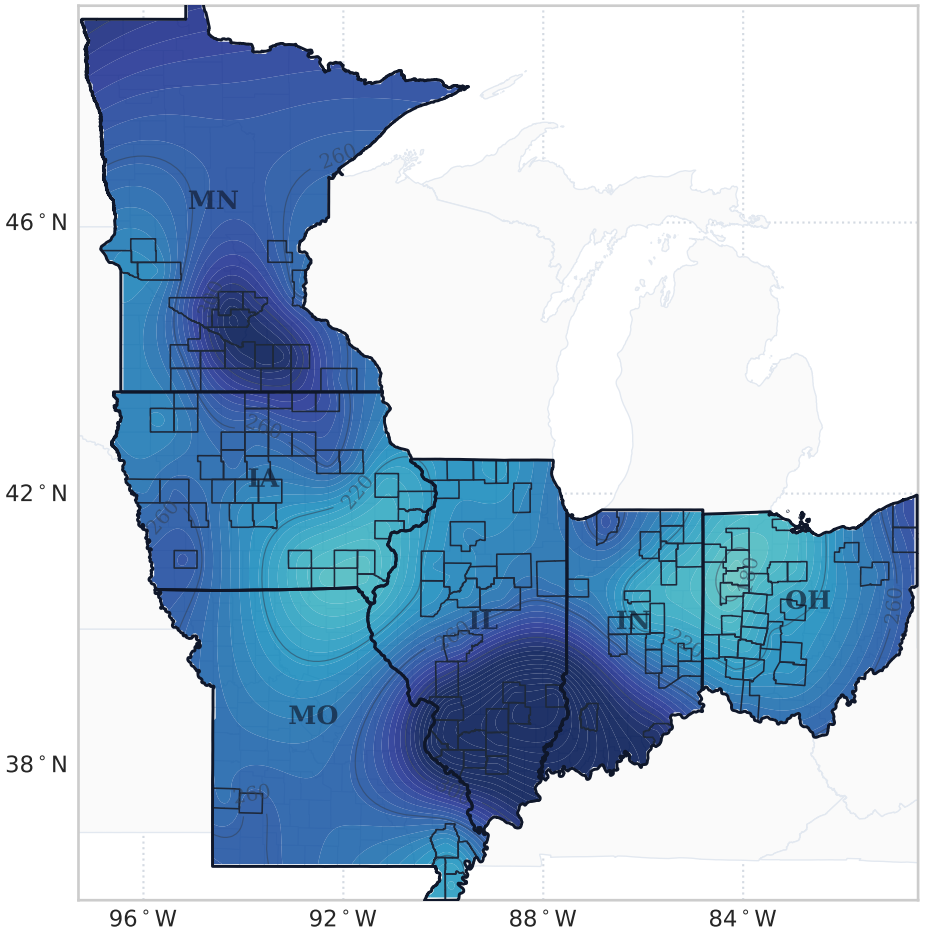
Negative Downside Shock (-11.7%) | Severe Rainfall Collapse (<80 mm in IL & IA)

(b) 2012 Flash Drought: July–August Max Temp (T_{max})



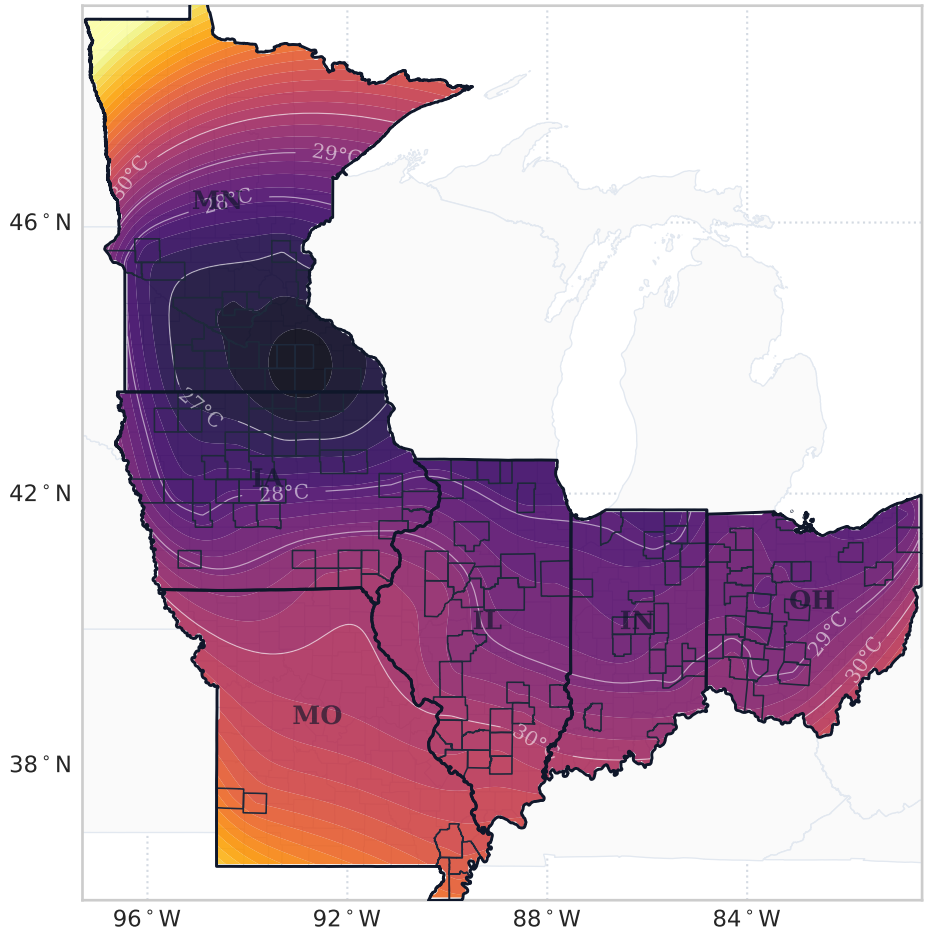
Negative Downside Shock (-11.7%) | Extreme Heat Waves (>33°C in Central/South)

(c) 2016 Climatic Optimum: July–August Rainfall (P)

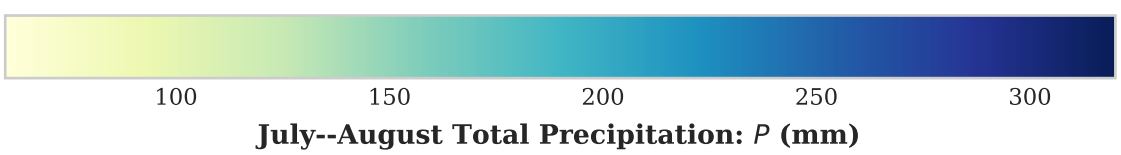


Positive Bumper Harvest (+10.8%) | Abundant Recharge Waves (>260 mm in Core Belt)

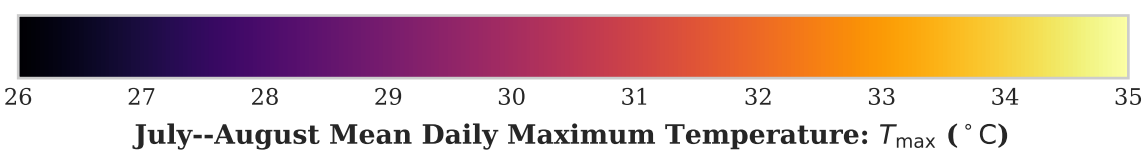
(d) 2016 Climatic Optimum: July–August Max Temp (T_{max})



Positive Bumper Harvest (+10.8%) | Consistently Mild Regimes (<29°C Region-Wide)



July--August Total Precipitation: P (mm)



July--August Mean Daily Maximum Temperature: T_{max} (°C)